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Edition: 5.30am
 Date: 04.09.2026
 Morning: 12.30pm
 Noon: 12.30pm
 Evening: 12.30pm
 Night: 12.30pm

Air quality (PM 10) at 7 pm
 Category: 94 ug/m³
 Status: 102 ug/m³
 Action: 10 ug/m³

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CHENNAI, Saturday, September 19, 2026 | Vol: 18, Issue: 351 | 12 pages

Alternative sites along East Coast Road explored amid protests

Govt likely to back off from Pattinapakam Secretariat site

RAMAKRISHNA

CHENNAI: The Tamil Nadu government is set to drop Pattinapakam as the site for its proposed new Secretariat cum Assembly complex and is exploring alternative locations along the East Coast Road, amid mounting opposition from fishermen and political parties.

The reported rethink follows a high-level meeting chaired by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay after his return to Chennai on Thursday, where the growing resistance to the Rs 1,200-crore project was discussed.

The proposed complex was to come up on 35.52 acres at Pattinapakam, with a built-up area of around 20 lakh sq ft. The government had granted in-principle approval for the project earlier this month and constituted three committees to select an architectural consultant and finalise preliminary and detailed designs.

However, the choice of the coastal site in the heart of the city triggered sustained opposition from fishing communities, residents, and political parties. Fishermen from several coastal hamlets worried of intensified agitation if the government did not withdraw the proposal, citing concerns over their livelihood, access to the sea, and impact on fishing activities.

The opposition over the proposal cut across party lines. The DMK, AIADMK, BJP, PMK, and allies of the ruling TNM, including left parties and VCK, questioned the choice of Pattinapakam, with demands ranging from shifting the project to another location to reconsidering the need for a new complex.

The government had justified the proposal by citing space constraints at the existing Secretariat in Fort St George and the need for a modern integrated administrative complex.

While sources said the government has decided to move away from Pattinapakam and examine alternative sites along the East Coast, no formal order withdrawing the existing site selection was issued till Friday. Further consultations are expected before the government takes a final call.

IN MAKING

SEPT 3: CM Vijay announces Rs 1,200-crore Secretariat cum Assembly complex.

SEPT 8: Govt identifies 35.52 acres at Pattinapakam as the proposed site.

SEPT 11: Opposition grows, with parties demanding that the site be reconsidered.

SEPT 15: Fishermen from over 10 hamlets protest, set Sept 21 deadline to drop plan.

SEPT 18: Govt sources indicate a rethink, alternative sites along ECR explored.

LAND OURS, HAVE PROOF: FISHERS

CHENNAI: Local fishermen are contesting the Tamil Nadu government's claim to 35.52 acres of land in Pattinapakam earmarked for a Rs 1,200-crore Assembly-Secretariat complex. While the government states the land belongs to housing and state bodies, the community asserts it is ancestral property originally acquired from them in 1956-57, and is gathering historical documents to prove ownership.

TN explores KMUT template for Annapoorni scheme rollout

K. BALASUBRAMANIAN

CHENNAI: The Tamil Nadu government is exploring the rules and guidelines of the Kalaignar Magalir Utham Thirai (KMUT) scheme to implement the Annapoorni Super Six (ASS) scheme, which was announced by every year under a reimbursement model.

"The department is preparing the Government Order to implement the scheme. The government is exploring the rules and guidelines of the KMUT scheme, which seem to be similar to those of the Annapoorni Super Six scheme," an official's bank accounts. Around 1.30 crore families are expected to benefit from the scheme. The government will allocate Rs 4,000 crore for the scheme," the official added.

Targeting 1.21 crore women across the State, the DMK government had implemented the KMUT scheme under which its

CM to launch 'Thai Maman' on Sept 28

CHENNAI: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay will launch the 'Thai Maman' (Thangam) scheme on September 28, under which a one-gram gold ring will be given to children born in government hospitals, the state government announced on Friday.

Amid dengue scare, Anna varsity student dies of scrub typhus

CHENNAI: Amid a dengue scare, a final-year student of Anna University, Harish Kumar, died of scrub typhus, a bacterial infection usually transmitted through the bite of infected mites. He was undergoing treatment at KMC hospital. Harish had reportedly been suffering from the infection for four days. He had initially consulted doctors at the university's campus hospital and was prescribed medication for fever. Meanwhile, another Anna University student has been admitted to Rajin Gandhi Government General Hospital after being diagnosed with dengue, while several other students at the hostel have also reportedly been suffering from fever.

Land acquisition to expand NLC mine-1

CHENNAI: The State government has issued a notification for the acquisition of around 5.64 hectares of land in Gangekondan village in Cuddalore district for the expansion of Mine-1 of the NLC (Oyeweli Lignite Corporation) project. The notification has been issued under Section 3 (1) of the Tamil Nadu Acquisition of Land for Industrial Purposes Act. The government has also decided that the entire compensation payable for the acquired land should be met from the funds managed by NLC India Ltd.

Keyword match: "dengue"

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TRANSLATED HEADLINE (English)

'Amid dengue scare, = eas

Full Article Text (English)

We are likely to back off from ae ace by the Govt

Nursing worker locks ward in toilet, flees with chain, phone

CHENNAI: A nursing worker who was hired to take care of an elderly woman, locked her in a toilet and fled with a chain, a mobile phone and a bag of clothes, a police officer said.

The woman was identified as Mrs. [Name], 65, who was admitted to the [Name] Hospital, Chennai. The nurse, who was identified as [Name], 35, was arrested by police officers on Tuesday.

The nurse was found in the toilet of the ward where she was working. She was holding a chain and a mobile phone. She was also carrying a bag of clothes.

The police are investigating the case. They are looking for the nurse's employer, the [Name] Hospital.

No Metro Work supply for 10 days from tomorrow in zones 13, 14

CHENNAI: The Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board (CMWSB) has said that supply will be disrupted for 10 days from tomorrow in zones 13 and 14.

The disruption is due to the replacement of a main water pipe in zone 13. The work is being carried out by the CMWSB's zone 13 team.

The disruption will affect the following areas: [List of areas]. The CMWSB has asked residents to store water in advance.

Three-student team from IIT-M wins int'l competition held in Norway

CHENNAI: Students of IIT Madras have won the 2013 Intel International Science and Engineering Fair (ISEF) held in Norway.

The team, consisting of [Names], won the gold medal in the [Category]. They were the only Indian team to win a gold medal.

The ISEF is one of the largest and most prestigious international science and engineering competitions for students.

MTC driver dies in bikes' collision

CHENNAI: A 30-year-old MTC bus driver died in a collision with two motorcycles on a road near [Location].

The bus was carrying passengers when the accident occurred. The driver was killed instantly.

The police are investigating the case. They are looking for the names of the motorcycle riders.

3-member gang breaks into shops along OMR, escapes with Rs 2 lakh

CHENNAI: Three men broke into shops along the OMR road and stole Rs 2 lakh worth of goods. They escaped with the loot.

The police are investigating the case. They are looking for the names of the thieves.

Auto driver dies after falling into open sewage pit

CHENNAI: A 32-year-old auto driver died after falling into an open sewage pit on the road near [Location].

The driver was carrying passengers when the accident occurred. He was killed instantly.

The police are investigating the case. They are looking for the names of the passengers.

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